

Nicole Kelner

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SUMMARY

Product builder with nine years in a product management function across consumer software, education, and climate. Shipped two consumer iOS apps solo from concept to App Store, instrumenting both end to end in Mixpanel and building a custom dashboard that consolidated three disconnected data sources into one view of activation, retention, and revenue. Cofounded a K-12 education company, scaled it from one location to five nationwide, 1,000 students, and \$1M in revenue before acquisition, and later led a cross-functional team of 10 at a consumer climate app on a \$1.6M Rockefeller Foundation budget. Spent four years inside the clean energy transition, commissioned by the U.S. Department of Energy's Loan Programs Office and working with Rocky Mountain Institute, Sunrun, and Activate to make electrification and distributed energy legible to the people adopting it.

EXPERIENCE

Mindful Tech Studio | Founder and Product Owner

New York, NY · 2025 – Present

- **Product ownership:** Took two consumer iOS apps from concept to App Store solo, owning problem definition, requirements, prioritization, implementation, release management, and QA. Free Time reached 1,000+ downloads, paying subscribers, and a 4.8-star rating with zero paid marketing.
- **Experimentation:** Instrumented the full funnel in Mixpanel, from first open through activation, paywall, purchase, and retention, then ran sequential onboarding experiments and used feature-level behavior data to decide what to build, refine, or cut.
- **Analytics tooling:** Built a custom dashboard integrating Mixpanel, RevenueCat, and App Store Connect, consolidating three disconnected sources into a single view so activation, retention, and revenue are analyzed against each other.
- **Adoption and trust:** Rebuilt onboarding around device-level Screen Time permissions that alarm users at first contact, on a product that does not function unless people willingly cede control of their device.
- **Device-state integration:** Shipped Unplug OS, a second iOS product whose unlock depends on hardware state rather than willpower, releasing apps only while the phone is charging. In beta, launching 2026.

Arts and Climate Change | Founder

New York, NY · 2022 – Present

- **Energy domain translation:** Turn electrification, home energy, and clean energy policy into material households and municipalities act on, working directly with scientists, engineers, and policy experts at Rocky Mountain Institute, Sunrun, Activate, Harvard, and MIT.
- **Federal client delivery:** Commissioned by the U.S. Department of Energy's Loan Programs Office to produce explanatory work on federal energy programs.
- **Public product:** Created an illustrated guide mapping every Inflation Reduction Act incentive to the specific part of a home it applies to. Reached 250,000 impressions, and local governments nationwide requested customized versions for their residents.
- **Audience growth:** Grew a platform from 0 to 55,000 followers and 6,000 subscribers through continuous format testing against engagement data, reaching 3M+ people. Named a Grist 50 Fixer for climate communications.

Dashboard.Earth | Head of Operations

New York, NY · 2021 – 2022

- **Cross-functional leadership:** Led a team of 10 across engineering, design, partnerships, and content at a consumer climate app, aligning stakeholders and sequencing what shipped.
- **Operating cadence:** Developed OKRs and built the processes connecting the product team with operations, design, and leadership.
- **Budget and reporting:** Owned a \$1.6M budget funded by the Rockefeller Foundation, tracking milestones and operational data and reporting to the funder on schedule.

Climate Finance Solutions | Chief of Staff

New York, NY · 2021 – 2022

- **Stakeholder communication:** Built the operational systems and briefing materials a small, high-output team ran on, supporting leadership across the clean energy finance and policy ecosystem including federal grant programs. The firm has since secured \$1.6B in grant funding for its climate clients.

The Coding Space | Cofounder and COO, then Head of Marketing

New York, NY · 2015 – 2020

- **0 to 1 and scale:** Cofounded a K-12 education company and owned the product from zero, scaling from 1 location to 5 nationwide, 1,000 students, and \$1M in revenue before acquisition.
- **Technical collaboration:** Helped build WoofJS, an open-source web platform used by thousands of students. Led user experience, contributed to frontend development, and translated user needs and architectural constraints into shipped features.
- **Team and quality systems:** Hired, trained, and supervised 50 staff, and built the documentation and quality standards that held delivery consistent across five markets.

SmartPurse | CEO and Founder

New York, NY · 2011 – 2015

- **Company building:** Founded a direct-to-consumer company and took it from concept to market, earning coverage in VOGUE UK, TechCrunch, and Mashable. Acquired by Betabrand in 2015.

PROJECTS

So You Want to Work in Climate | Founder and Product Lead

Open-source web database · 1,000+ resources · 25,000 views in first six months

- **Requirements and delivery:** Wrote the brief, requirements, and user stories, managed an external development team through delivery, and launched a structured, searchable database. Designed the taxonomy so a first-time visitor could find what applied to them.
- **Impact:** Grew from an empty spreadsheet to 1,000+ contributed resources and 25,000 views in six months, with users reporting they landed climate jobs through it.

SKILLS

Product: hypothesis definition and validation, discovery and user research, roadmap and backlog ownership, requirements and documentation, prioritization and sequencing, leading technical projects from ambiguity to delivery

Data and Analytics: funnel instrumentation, conversion experiments, success metric definition, feature-level behavior analysis, cross-source dashboards, client and funder data reporting, Mixpanel, RevenueCat, App Store Connect

Energy and Climate: distributed energy resources, electrification and home energy, residential solar, IRA tax incentives, clean energy finance, federal energy programs, grid decarbonization

Cross-Functional: aligning engineering, design, sales, and leadership, executive and stakeholder communication, external partner management, translating technical material for non-technical audiences

Technical: Claude Code, Xcode, Figma, Notion, frontend development, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript literacy

EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania Executive Program in Social Impact Strategy (2020)

Penn State University B.S. Communications, Minor in Engineering Entrepreneurship (2015)

RECOGNITION

Grist 50 Fixer Award for climate communications. Harvard C-Change Creator to Watch. Shark Tank finalist. Alibaba Women Empowerment Award. Published with Rizzoli. Featured in Forbes, Washington Post, The Verge, The Guardian, VOGUE UK, TechCrunch, and Mashable.